

A whimsical illustration of a mouse climbing a ladder to reach a giant strawberry. The mouse is small, with grey fur and large ears, perched on a yellow ladder. It is reaching up towards a massive, bright red strawberry that dominates the center of the frame. The strawberry has a green leafy top and is surrounded by other green leaves. The background is a soft, hazy landscape with more foliage.

**The Little Mouse,
The Red Ripe Strawberry, and
THE BIG HUNGRY BEAR**

by Don and Audrey Wood

illustrated by Don Wood

 **SCHOLASTIC**

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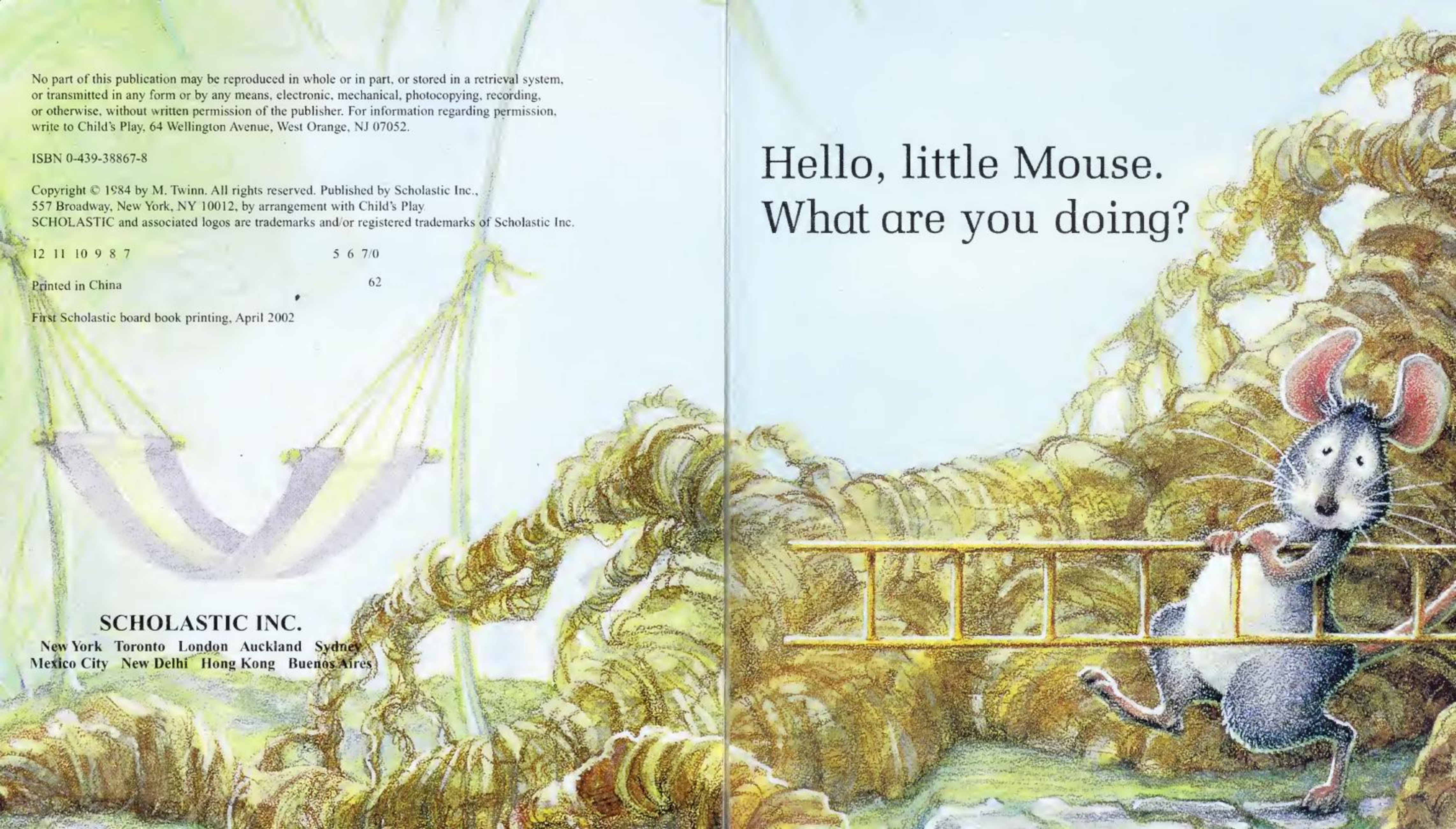
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Hello, little Mouse.
What are you doing?





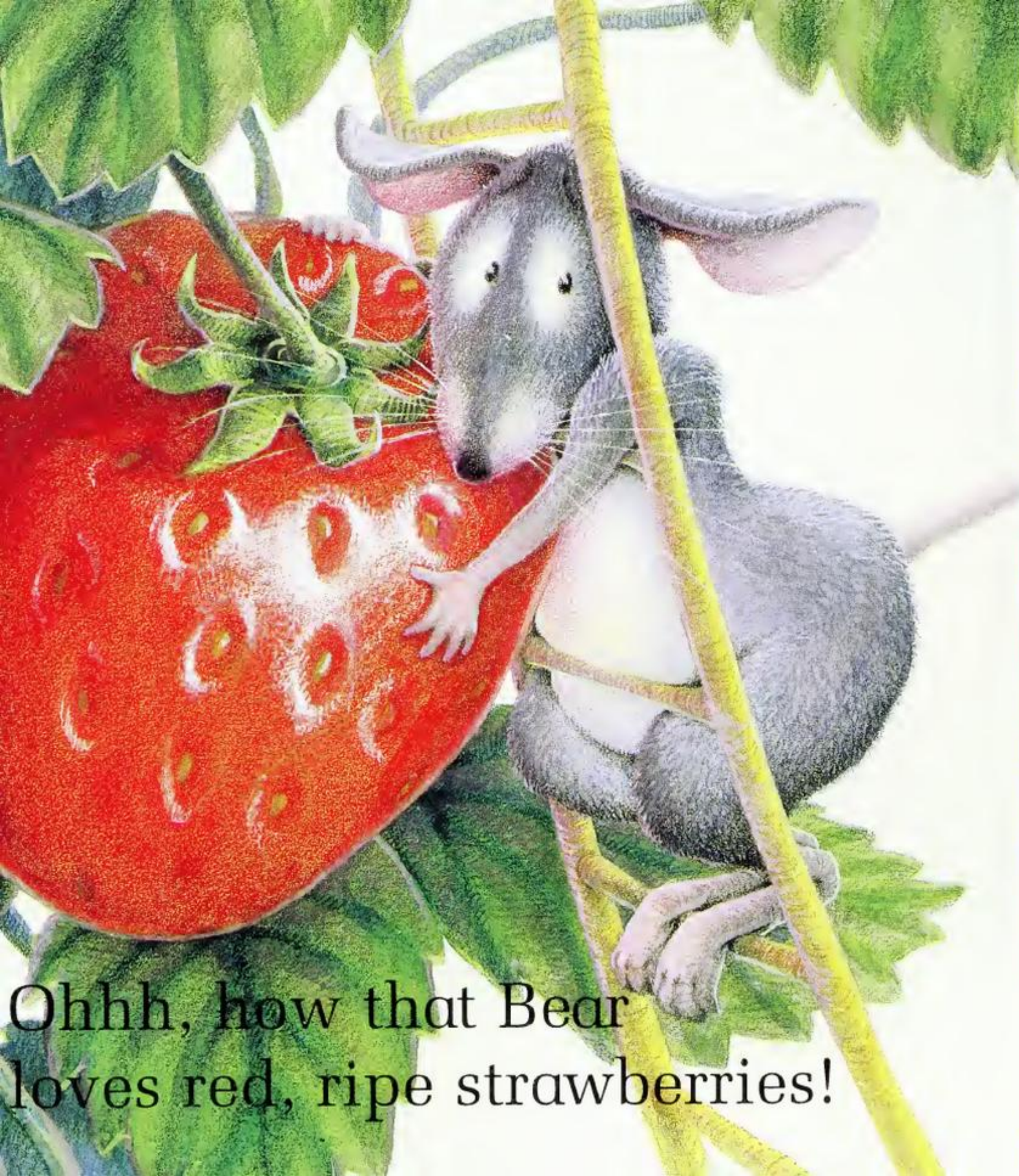
Oh, I see.

Are you going to pick
that red, ripe strawberry?

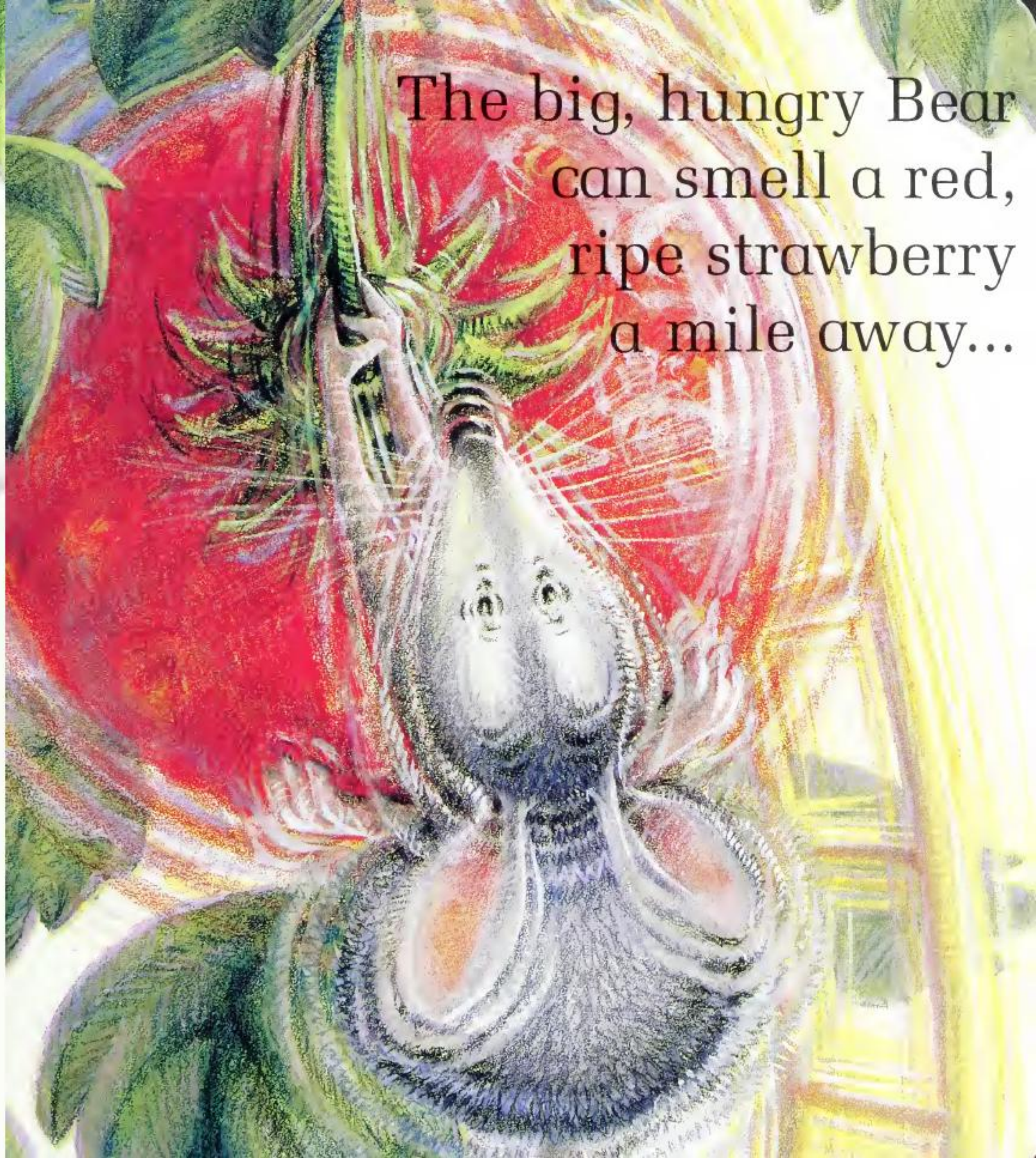


But, little Mouse,
haven't you heard
about the big,
hungry Bear?



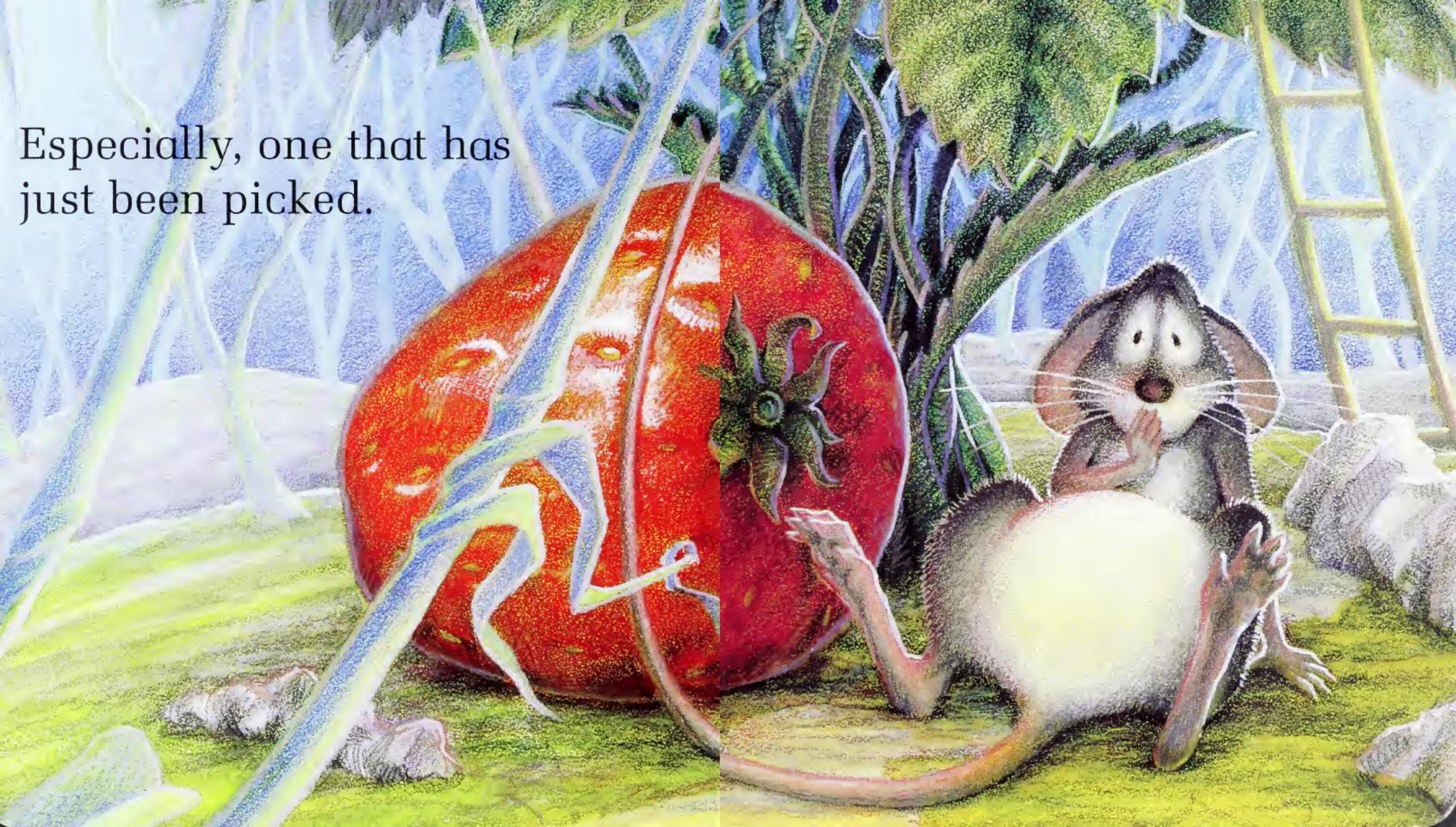


Ohhh, how that Bear
loves red, ripe strawberries!

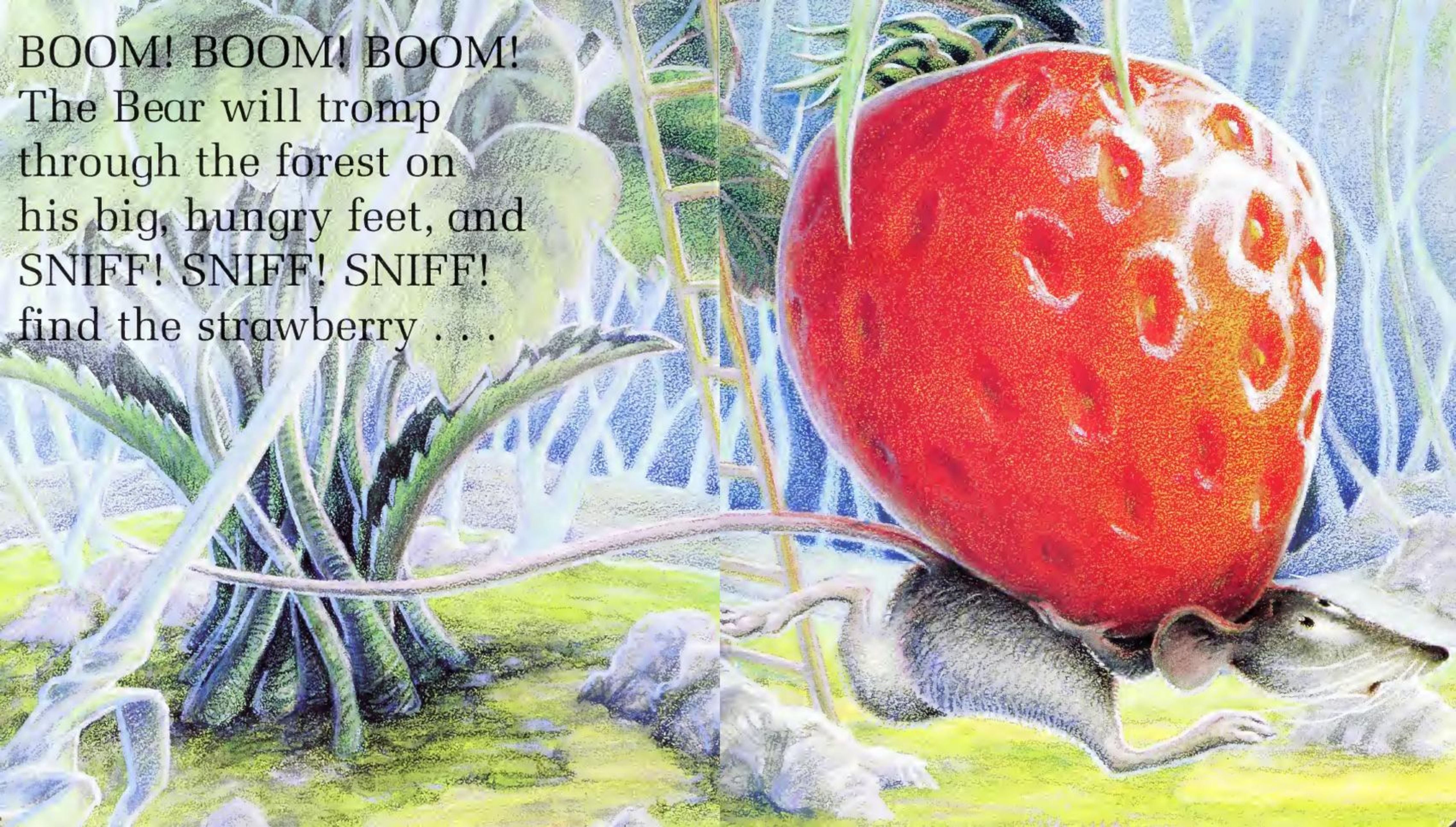


The big, hungry Bear
can smell a red,
ripe strawberry
a mile away...

Especially, one that has
just been picked.

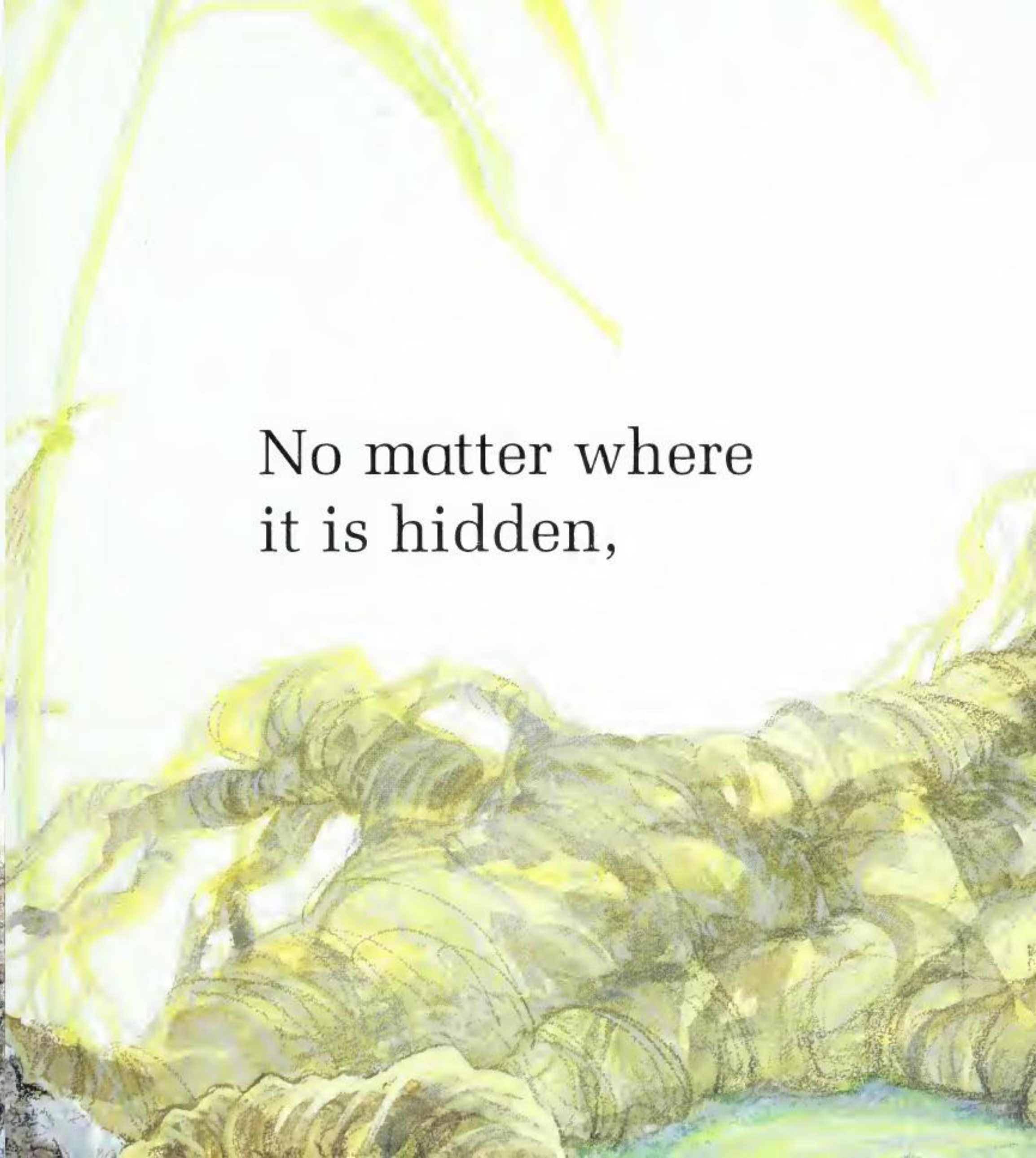


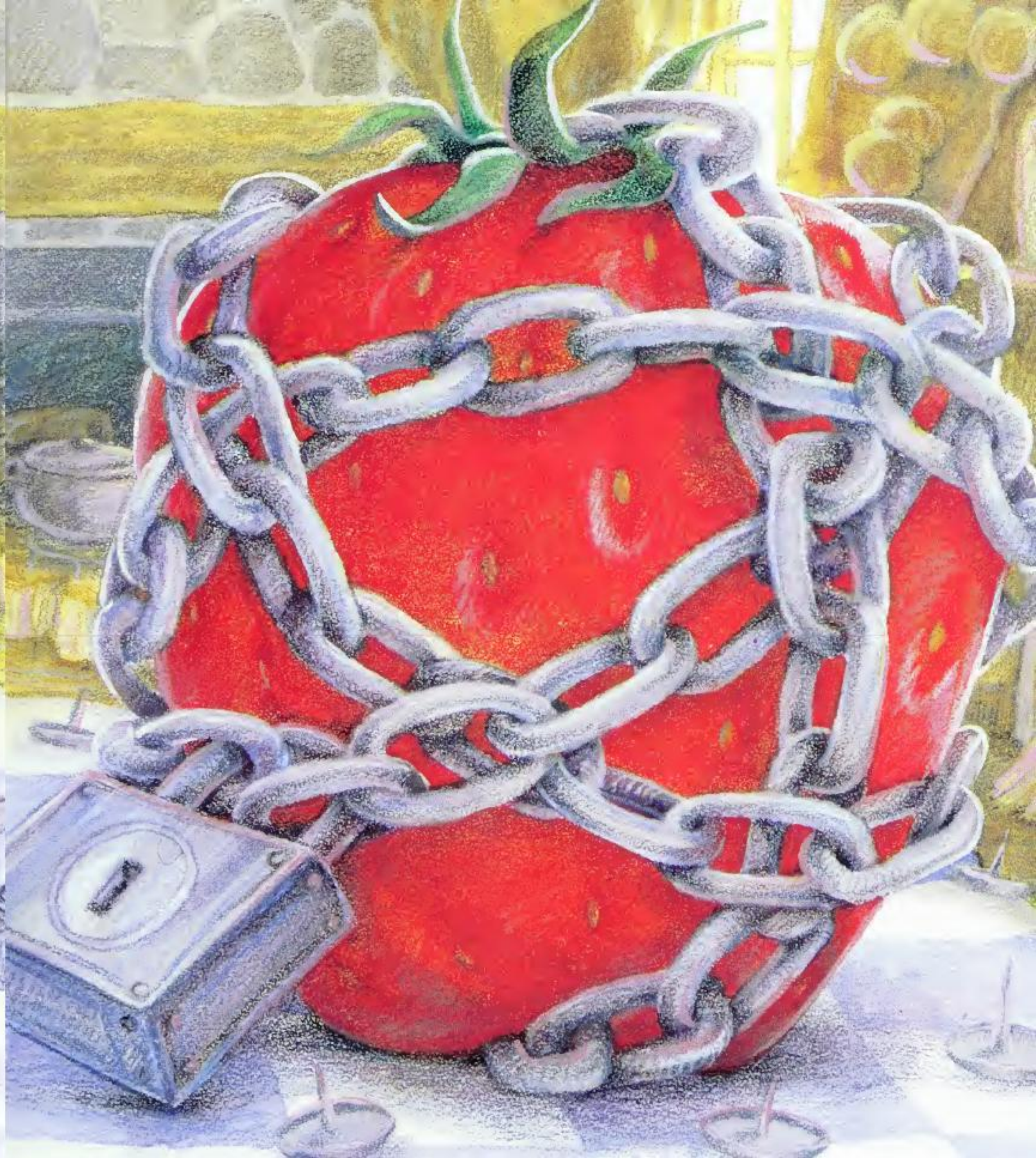
BOOM! BOOM! BOOM!
The Bear will tromp
through the forest on
his big, hungry feet, and
SNIFF! SNIFF! SNIFF!
find the strawberry . . .





No matter where
it is hidden,



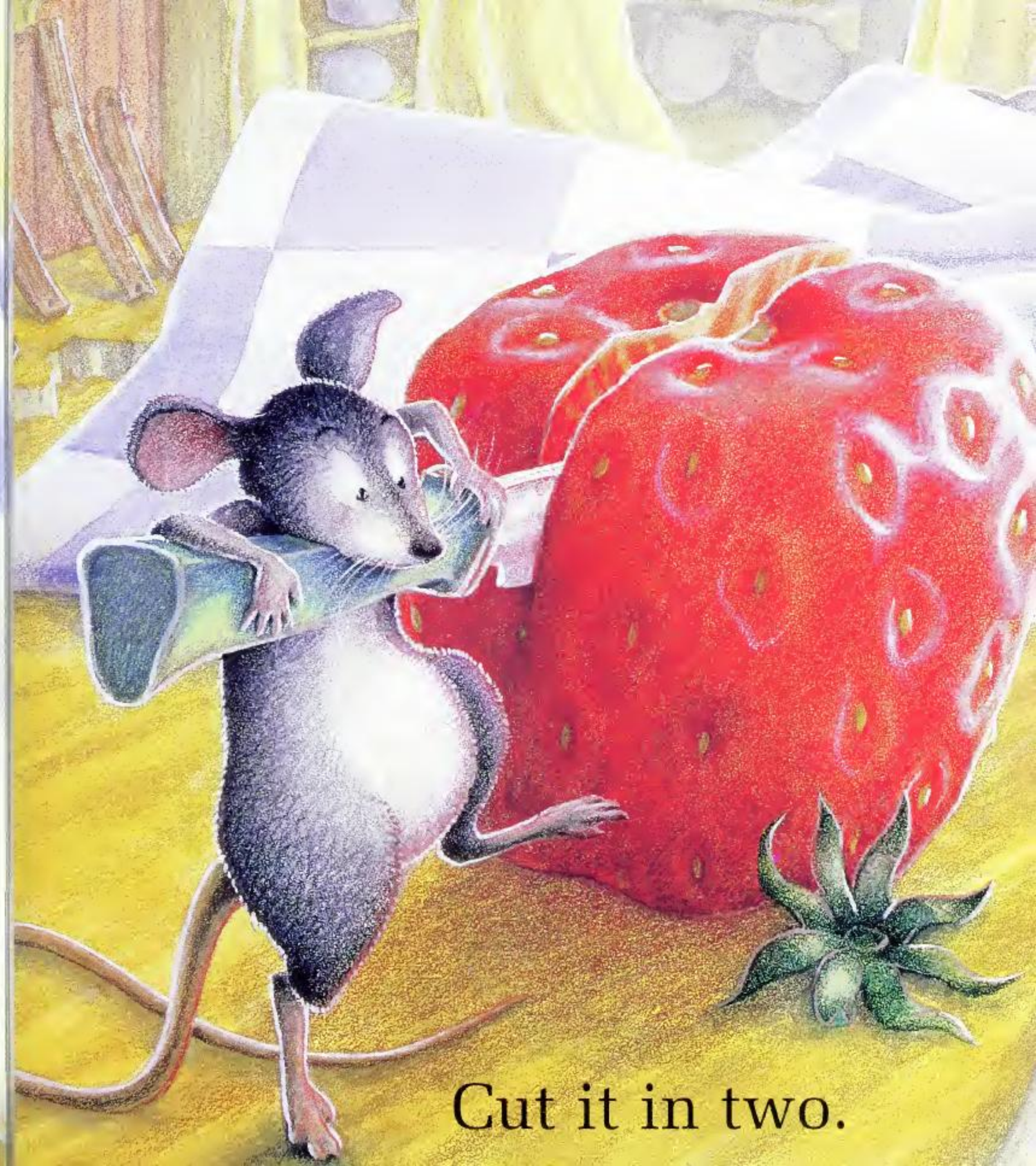
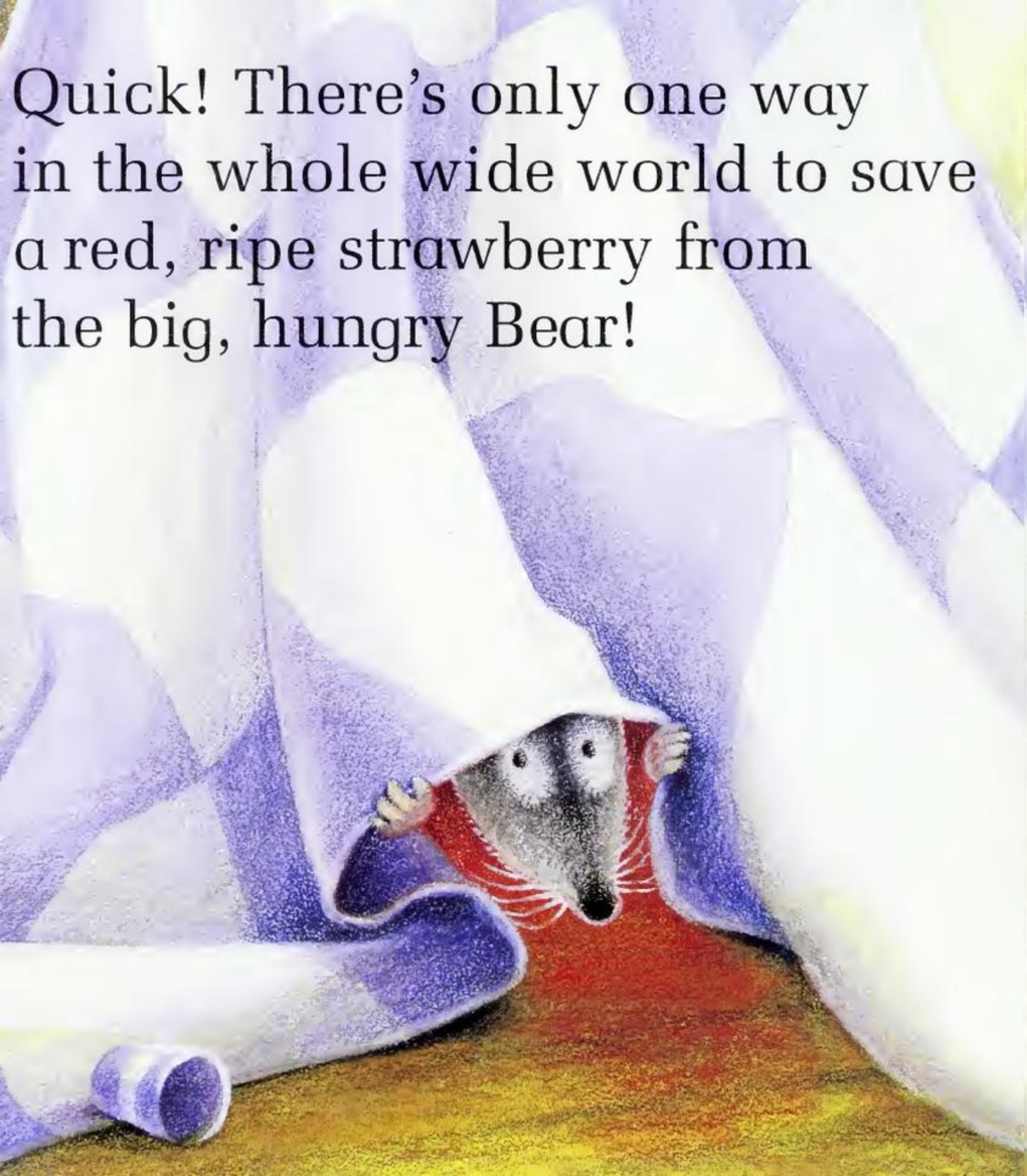


or who is guarding it,

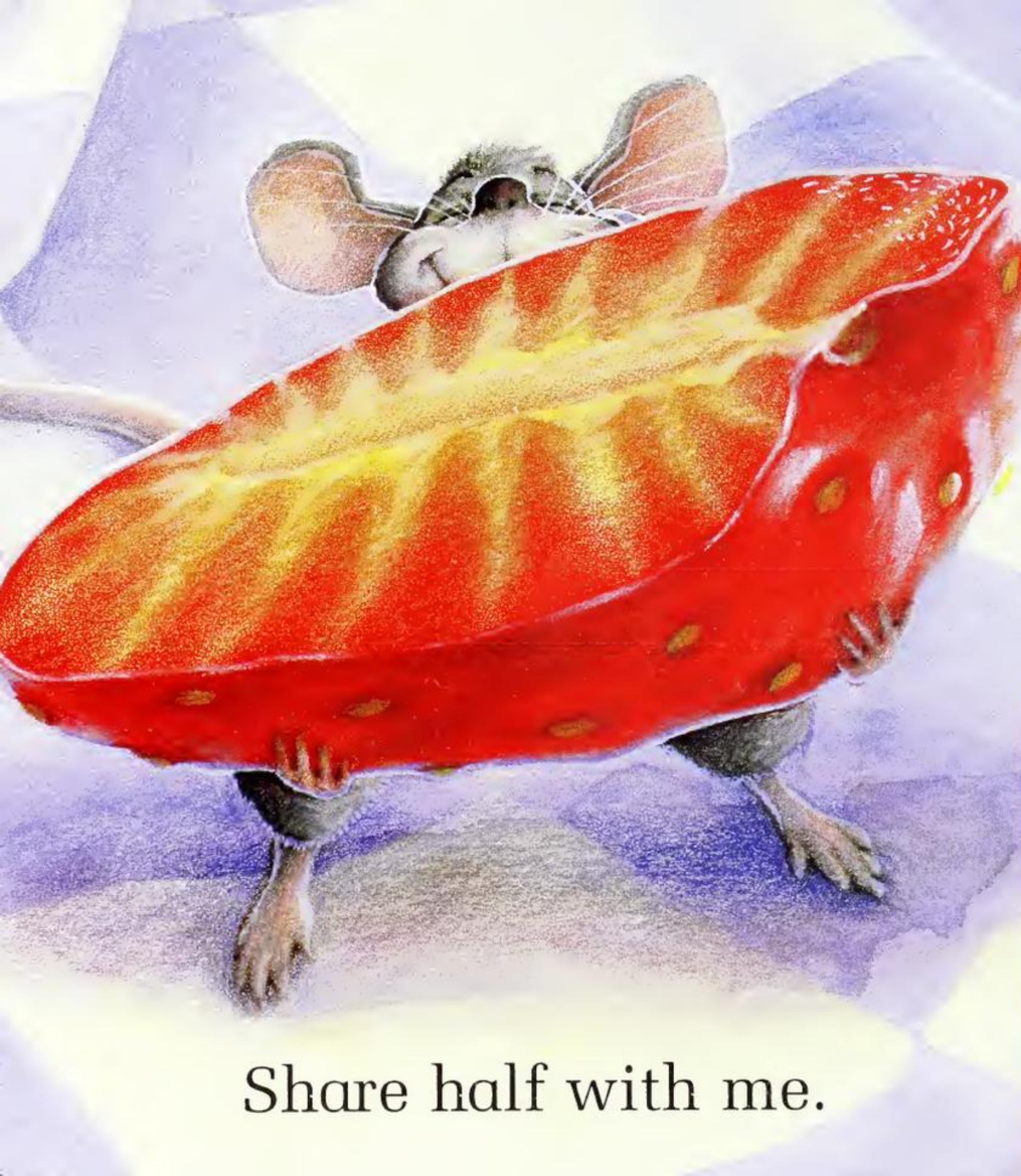
or how it is disguised.



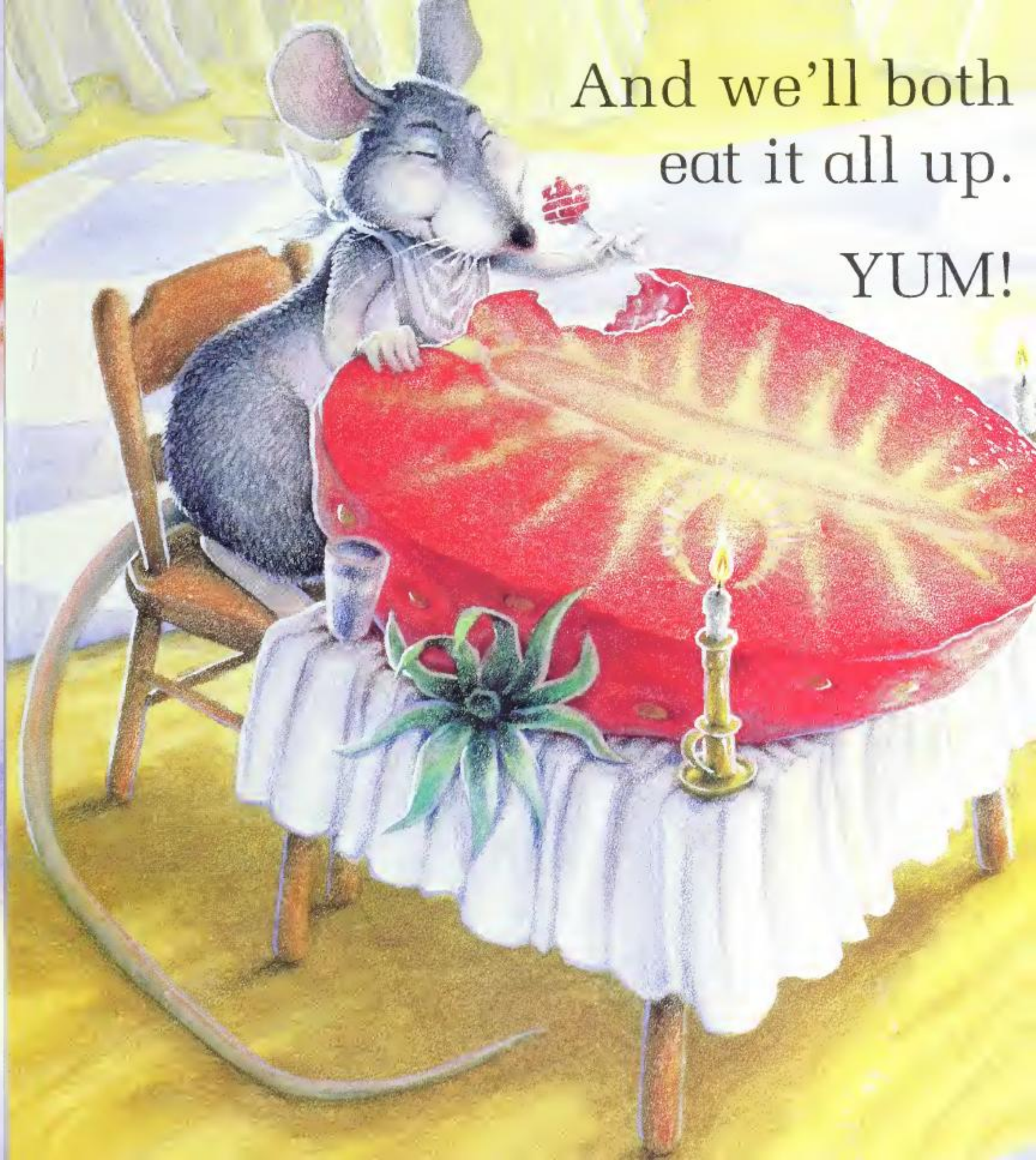
Quick! There's only one way
in the whole wide world to save
a red, ripe strawberry from
the big, hungry Bear!



Cut it in two.



Share half with me.



And we'll both
eat it all up.
YUM!

Now, that's one
red, ripe strawberry
the big, hungry Bear
will never get!



The End

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